SIREN'S SONG

Concept-art image review & working design handoff

Prepared 18 October 2026 | Source: successive visual generations and conversation critiques. Intended for the concept-art Work chat.

Executive decision: Preserve the current USS Quietus exterior as a provisional visual reference. It looks sufficiently functional for placeholder concept art. Stop iterating on internal loading geometry unless a future image has an obvious external contradiction. Return effort to the top-down 2D seabed, tactical gameplay readability, vehicle silhouettes, and environment exploration.

Established art direction: Grounded painterly / stylized military sci-fi; compact experimental one-pilot US reconnaissance sub; dark angular Sirens in different sizes and configurations, often with red lights; alien brutalist factory with cyan/turquoise industrial light and amber manufacturing zones; rocky trenches, basalt and eroded seabed; separate physical objects and sensor overlays.

Reading guide

Each image is embedded with its original iteration-specific assessment. Visual ratings and mechanical judgments are qualitative; these are image-generation concepts, not manufacturing drawings. Some variants have near-identical compositions, which is itself a key workflow finding.

01 · Original cinematic exploration

Strong underwater brutalist factory, angular red-lit Siren and readable combat staging. Quietus looked assembled sideways: ambiguous bow-to-stern axis, oversized lateral ducted fans, perched cockpit. Preserve composition, palette, factory and Siren; reject original submarine geometry.

02 · First longitudinal hull correction

Quietus acquires a pointed bow and coherent longitudinal body, but the twin ducted propulsion pods still read as aircraft-style equipment. Drone launch hardware remains absent. Good material language.

03 · Rear-facing propulsion and underwater effects

Rear-facing propulsion and underwater particulate effects improve. Bubble clouds become overabundant, implying noisy cavitation or unexplained gas release. Physical drones and torpedo launch compatibility still unresolved.

04 · Tube-compatible drones and boiling beam

Drone scale improves and small cylindrical craft are more plausible. Tube openings remain ambiguous; flash-boiling effect reads partly as airborne flame/smoke. Quietus hull continues to carry excessive exposed equipment.

05 · Conventional screw iteration

Aft-mounted conventional screw establishes the correct propulsion direction. Sail remains too tall, hull heavily segmented, and frothy wake inconsistent with stealth operation. Factory and Siren remain excellent.

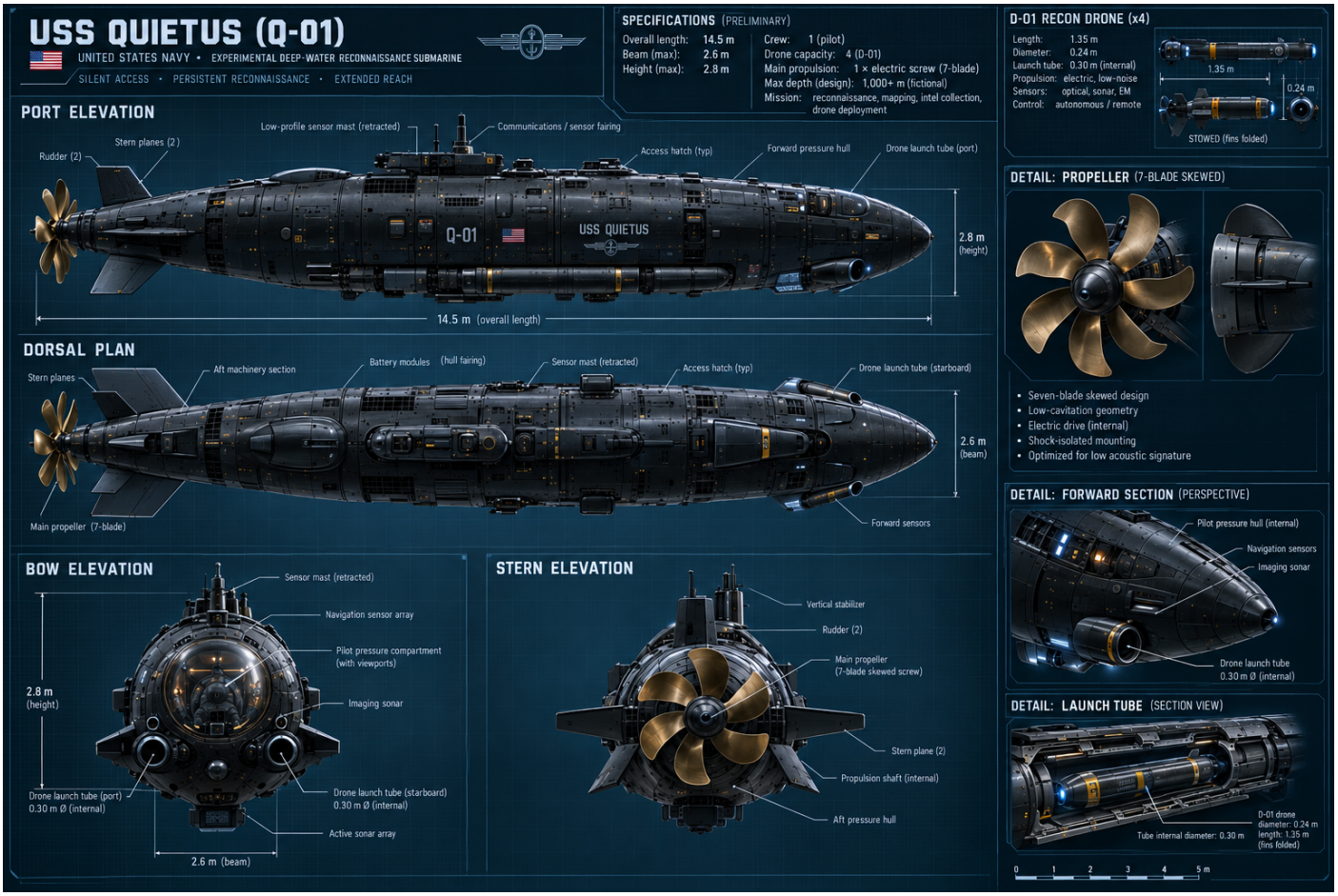
06 · Full-scene correction attempt

Scene quality remains high but major functional corrections do not reliably persist: oversize external launch cylinders, frothy wake, smoky beam and oversized sensor structures. Demonstrates limits of repeated whole-scene regeneration.

08 · First engineering collage

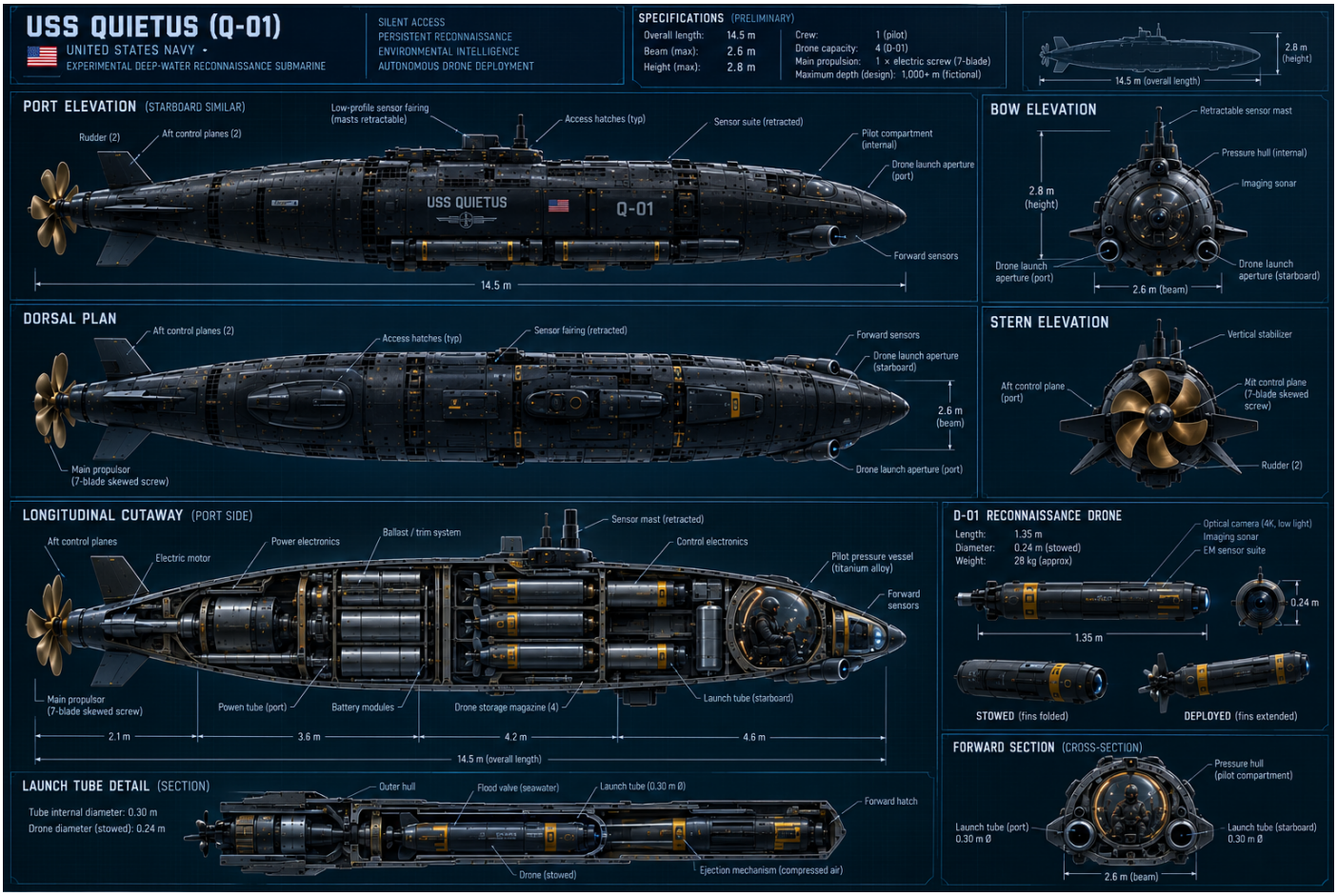
Technical views, cutaways, and drone launch sequence make the architecture inspectable. Printed 28.4 m length is excessive for the desired compact single-pilot design. 0.21 m drones versus 0.533 m tubes require a carrier/adapter. View consistency and cockpit pressure boundary remain weak.

09 · Orthographic exterior sheet



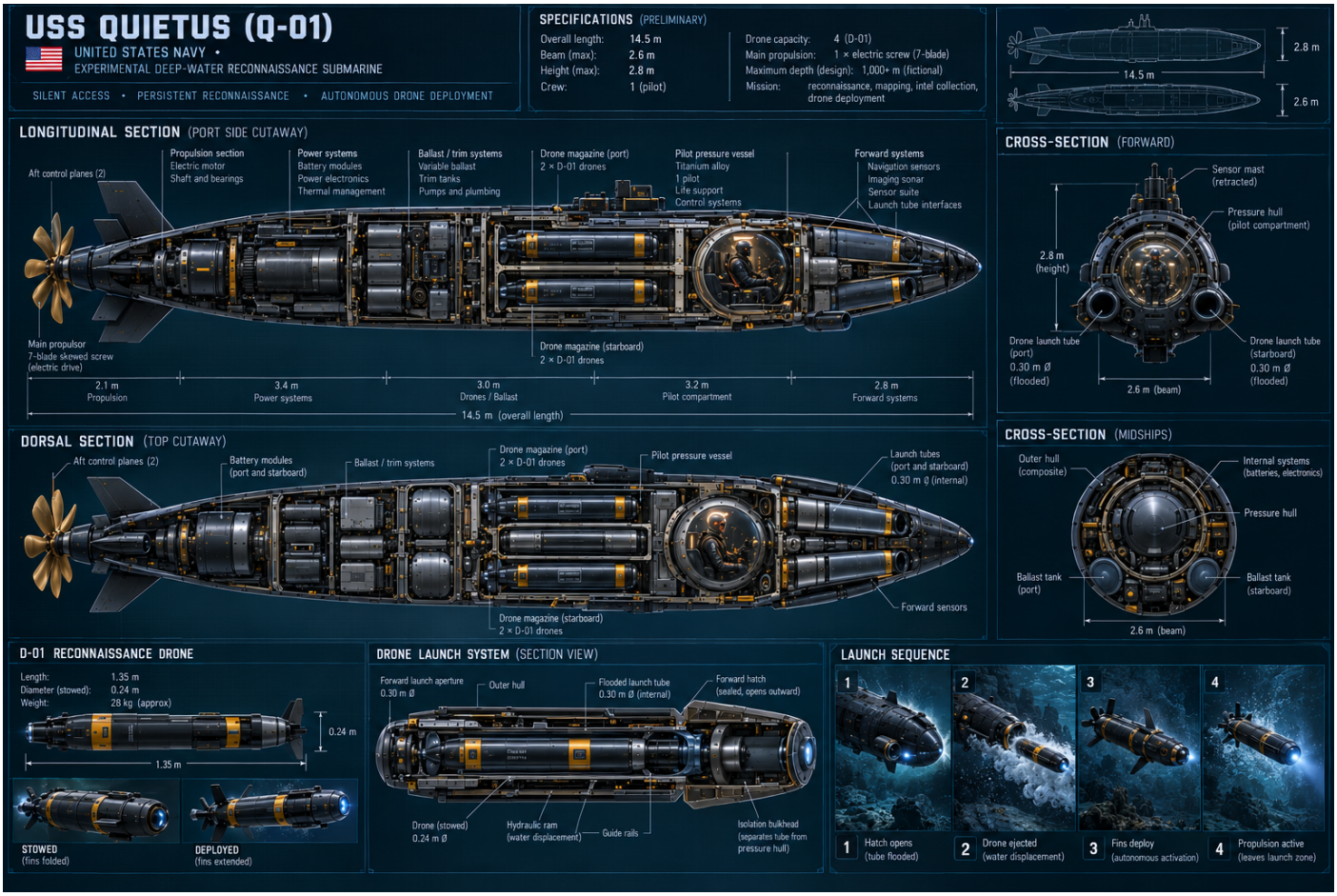
Establishes preliminary 14.5 m length, 2.6 m beam, 2.8 m height; two 0.30 m forward tubes; 1.35 m by 0.24 m drones; central seven-bladed screw. Strongest early exterior design. Front cockpit window and side/top tube treatment disagree.

10 · Orthographic + cutaway revision



Exterior silhouettes and aft screw converge. Cutaway depicts four-drone storage but no convincing continuous feed path to forward tubes; pilot compartment intrudes into routing. Tube detail and cross-sections remain illustrative.

11 · Internal packaging study



Best internal-architecture illustration: distinct drive, power, ballast, drones, pilot and sensor zones. Longitudinal and dorsal cuts disagree on drone count/placement; magazines still do not show a continuous feed into shoulder launch tubes. Useful as concept support, not verified engineering.

Cross-image conclusions

Consistently successful: cold blue-green atmosphere; monumental layered brutalist industrial factory; cyan/amber lighting; dark faceted Siren with restrained red highlights; strong cinematic foreground-to-background depth; focused red beam as a storytelling element.

Converged sufficiently: Quietus as a 14.5 m preliminary concept, tapered bow, clear longitudinal axis, aft central submarine screw, charcoal naval coating, subtle markings, small cylindrical drones and forward launch apertures. These figures are exploratory, not ratified physical specifications.

Recurring failure modes: generator invents unrelated mechanical details between views; side/top/cross-sections contradict; drones are not always visibly compatible with launch tubes; externally mounted cylinders replace integrated tubes; beam vapor clouds resemble smoke; excessive bubbles and froth around a covert submarine; high-detail surface clutter; whole-scene regeneration changes already-good parts.

Working guidance for the concept-art chat

• Prioritize the first gameplay cross-section: stylized-realistic top-down seabed, readable obstacles and routes, a Quietus, two independently acting drones, a Siren attacking one drone, the other photographing, and a distant alien brutalist factory.

• Use the best cinematic scene as mood and world reference; use the orthographic exterior as a silhouette reference. Neither is a mandatory exact model.

• Explore multiple artistic treatments and compositions, rather than spending every generation on small engineering corrections. Vary camera, water visibility, vehicle prominence, Siren classes and factory prominence.

• Keep movement routes, waypoints, sensor contacts and target indicators legible and visually separate from the physical mass of craft and terrain.

• Underwater motion: suspended particles and silt, localized geological bubbles, restrained wake during stealth movement. The beam can produce localized violent vapor cavities/bubbles and fragments at its energy-deposition region; avoid continuous airborne-looking smoke.

• When a visible feature is clearly implausible, make a targeted correction. Stop when external plausibility is achieved. Do not reopen speculative internal mechanics without a gameplay or design reason.

Reference hierarchy

1. Project design bible and visual exploration handoff for gameplay and world constraints. 2. User-approved art-direction choices in this review. 3. Cinematic images for atmosphere and alien architecture. 4. Latest exterior engineering sheets for Quietus silhouette. Internal cutaways remain exploratory.